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Attorneys for Defendants
KATIE PALACIOS and HOPE PROGRAM

SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA

COUNTY OF SAN JOAQUIN

BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI, Plaintiff, v. KATIE PALACIOS, Clinical Director, HOPE Program (Stockton, California), an individual; HOPE PSYCHOTHERAPY, INC., d/b/a HOPE PROGRAM, a California corporation; and DOES 1-10, inclusive, Defendants.	Case No.: STK-CV-UF-2026-0001032 **DECLARATION OF BLAZE VAN DINE IN SUPPORT OF DEFENDANTS KATIE PALACIOS AND HOPE PROGRAM'S DEMURRER TO PLAINTIFF'S FIRST AMENDED COMPLAINT** **Date:** **Time:** **Dept.:** Complaint Filed: February 10, 2026 Trial Date: TBD

I, BLAZE VAN DINE, declare as follows:

1. I am an attorney duly licensed to practice law in the State of California and before this Court. I am an associate at the law firm of Sims, Lawrence, & Broghammer, attorneys of record for Defendants KATIE PALACIOS and HOPE PROGRAM in this action. This declaration is submitted in support of Defendants' Demurrer to Plaintiff's First Amended Complaint. Unless otherwise stated on information and belief, the following facts are personally known to me and if called upon as a witness to testify, I could and would competently do so.

2. On May 15, 2026, Plaintiff and I met and conferred telephonically regarding Defendants' demurrer.

3. Despite a good faith effort, the parties did not reach an agreement resolving the objections raised in the demurrer.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the foregoing is true and correct. Executed on May 22, 2026, at Roseville, California.

BLAZE VAN DINE

PROOF OF SERVICE

I, Kim Schmitt, certify and declare as follows:

I am over the age of 18 years, and not a party to this action. My business address is 1478 Stone Point Drive, Suite 450, Roseville, CA 95661. My business email is: kschmitt@sims-lawnet. I am employed in the County of Placer where this service occurs.

On the date set forth below, following ordinary business practice, I served a true copy of the foregoing document(s) described as:

DECLARATION OF BLAZE VAN DINE IN SUPPORT OF DEFENDANTS KATIE PALACIOS AND HOPE PROGRAM'S DEMURRER TO PLAINTIFF'S FIRST AMENDED COMPLAINT

☐ (BY MAIL) I am readily familiar with my employer's normal business practice for collection and processing of correspondence for mailing with the U.S. Postal Service. Correspondence so collected and processed is deposited with the U.S. Postal Service that same day in the ordinary course of business. I placed for deposit in the United States Postal Service in a sealed envelope, with postage fully prepaid, to the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY PERSONAL SERVICE) I personally delivered the above document(s) by hand between 9:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. to the office of the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY OVERNIGHT DELIVERY) I deposited in a box or other facility regularly maintained by Federal Express an express service carrier, or delivered to a courier or driver authorized by said express service carrier to receive such envelope(s) to be delivered by overnight delivery, with delivery fees paid or provided for, addressed to the person(s) on whom it is to be served below.

☒ (BY ELECTRONIC SERVICE) I transmitted via electronic service through electronic mail to the offices of the addressee(s) below as stated on the attached service list on this date before 5:00 p.m.

SEE ATTACHED SERVICE LIST

☒ (State) I certify and declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed on: May 22, 2026

Kim Schmitt

SERVICE LIST

Brendan Ngehsi Newanforbi Plaintiff, in Pro Per 1455 Cat Tail Drive Stockton, CA 95204 (209) 801-4442 E: bnn.cdl@gmail.com	**PLAINTIFF, IN PER**